PSYCHOLOGICAL/COGNITIVE FALSE BELIEF #51 · PTSD

“Nowhere is really safe. Danger is about to happen again.”

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Where it often comes from

After something overwhelming, the nervous system often stays on duty. A sudden noise, a crowded room, or a quiet night can all feel like the moment before it happens again. That alarm once made sense. The lie is the conclusion that nowhere is really safe, and that danger is certainly about to return. Safety can be wise. A whole world with no safe place is a belief, not a map. A counselor can help you work with this at a pace that is safe. You do not have to do it alone, or all at once.

What Scripture teaches

God does not tell wounded people that the world has no danger in it. He says He is a refuge and strength, an ever-present help in trouble. “The LORD is my light and my salvation— whom shall I fear?” He is with you, and He will not forsake you. Even in the valley, the psalmist says, “You are with me.” These verses do not promise that nothing painful will ever happen again. They promise that you are not left without a refuge, and that “nowhere” is too big a word.

> *“God is our refuge and strength, an ever-present help in times of trouble”* (Psalm 46:1).

Also see

> “The LORD is my light and my salvation— whom shall I fear? The LORD is the stronghold of my life— whom shall I dread?” (Psalm 27:1).

> “Do not fear, for I am with you; do not be afraid, for I am your God. I will strengthen you; I will surely help you; I will uphold you with My right hand of righteousness” (Isaiah 41:10).

> “Even though I walk through the valley of the shadow of death, I will fear no evil, for You are with me; Your rod and Your staff, they comfort me” (Psalm 23:4).

> “The LORD Himself goes before you; He will be with you. He will never leave you nor forsake you. Do not be afraid or discouraged” (Deuteronomy 31:8).

Common self-statements

- It is about to happen again.
- I cannot let my guard down anywhere.
- Safe people do not understand.
- If I relax, I am asking for it.
- Every reminder is a warning.
- There is no point going out.

Common logical errors

- Overgeneralization: Turning one unsafe experience into “nowhere is safe.”
- Fortune telling: Deciding the danger is about to return because your body expects it.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling unsafe and treating the feeling as a fact about every place.
- Catastrophizing: Reading an ordinary moment as the start of the worst.

Challenging questions

- What is actually happening right now, apart from the alarm?
- Is there one place, or one person, that has been safe enough?
- Am I responding to a memory, or to a present threat?
- What would "safe enough for the next hour" look like?
- What does God promise about being with me, not about a danger-free world?
- What has my counselor suggested I do when this alarm gets loud?

Truth summary

> The world is not perfectly safe, and I am not without a refuge. God is with me, and I can look for safety one real place at a time.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

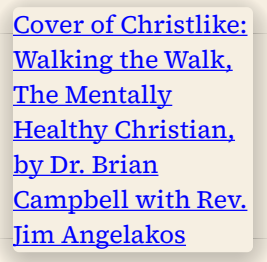
- Fear
- Anxiety/Worry
- Trust
- Peace
- God, Present Everywhere

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Anxiety/Worry/Fear
- Trouble/Hardship
- Suffering

What does a mentally healthy Christian look like?



From *Christlike: Walking the Walk* by Dr. Brian Campbell. A portrait, verse by verse, of how a mentally healthy Christian thinks, feels, and lives.

Read excerpts from "The Mentally Healthy Christian" (with every Scripture written out)

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Whom Shall I Fear — Chris Tomlin
God is a stronghold. The world does not have to feel safe before He is with you.

Battle Belongs — Phil Wickham
You can hand the fear of the next blow to God.

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
You can tell the truth about danger without deciding the whole world is unsafe.

Because He Lives — Bill and Gloria Gaither
Because Jesus lives, this moment is not the only moment there will ever be.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, what is one step I could take today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "Nowhere is really safe. Danger is about to happen again."

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"Nowhere is really safe. Danger is about to happen again." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What is actually happening right now, apart from the alarm?
- ☐ Is there one place, or one person, that has been safe enough?
- ☐ Am I responding to a memory, or to a present threat?
- ☐ What would "safe enough for the next hour" look like?
- ☐ What does God promise about being with me, not about a danger-free world?
- ☐ What has my counselor suggested I do when this alarm gets loud?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ The world is not perfectly safe, and I am not without a refuge. God is with me, and I can look for safety one real place at a time.
- ☐ I can be careful without deciding that nowhere is safe.
- ☐ God is a refuge in trouble, not only after trouble is gone.
- ☐ A trigger is not the same thing as the danger returning.
- ☐ I can name one place, or one person, that is safe enough for today.
- ☐ I do not have to prove the whole world is safe before I rest.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Psalm 46:1
  "God is our refuge and strength, an ever-present help in times of trouble."
- ☐ Psalm 27:1
  "The LORD is my light and my salvation— whom shall I fear? The LORD is the stronghold of my life— whom shall I dread?"
- ☐ Isaiah 41:10
  "Do not fear, for I am with you; do not be afraid, for I am your God. I will strengthen you; I will surely help you; I will uphold you with My right hand of righteousness."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ When nowhere felt safe: Each day, write down one moment when the alarm said danger was about to return. Write what happened, what you told yourself, and one more accurate statement.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Psalm 46:1 becomes: "Sarah can write: "God is my refuge. This feeling is not the whole map.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Fear" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio or the Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If this belief comes with hopelessness or thoughts of ending your life, call or text 988 (the Suicide & Crisis Lifeline), or call 911 in an emergency. You do not have to carry this alone.

- ☐ Name now versus then. Write "Then" and "Now" in two words each. Do not add the story. Ask whether the danger is in the room today.
- ☐ Use one safe anchor. With your counselor's guidance, choose one place or person that is safe enough, and stay there for a short, planned time.
- ☐ Do not scan the whole world. When the alarm says "nowhere," list three ordinary things that are steady right now.
- ☐ Tell your counselor how often this alarm comes, and follow the plan you make together. You do not have to figure the pace out alone.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

What I learned: _____

The lie "Nowhere is really safe. Danger is about to happen again.": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	A moment that was safer than the alarm said
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Nowhere is really safe. Danger is about to happen again~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, my body says nowhere is safe. Be my refuge here. Help me tell the difference between a memory and a present danger, and give me one safe place for today. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.